DUBAI PODCAST STUDIO — TECHNICAL IMPLEMENTATION

Spatial Audio. From Tomorrow.

A step-by-step technical implementation guide — what to download today, what to install this week, and how to be producing and marketing spatial audio content within 7 days. Total budget: under AED 1,200.

START DATE
Tomorrow morning

FIRST DELIVERABLE
Day 3 — first spatial test episode

COMMERCIAL LAUNCH
Day 14

BUDGET
AED 0 – 1,200

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00 — READ THIS FIRST

The Critical Distinction You Need to Understand

THE MOST IMPORTANT TECHNICAL CLARIFICATION IN THIS DOCUMENT

When people say "Dolby Atmos room certification," they mean a full cinema/music production facility — a 7.1.4 speaker array, treated room, Dolby site visit, months of work, and significant investment. **That is NOT what DPS needs.**

For podcasts, the correct format is **binaural spatial audio** — a software-only process that creates full 3D immersive audio delivered as a standard stereo file. It works on every pair of headphones, on every platform, with no special equipment needed by

the listener. This is what Apple AirPods, Spotify, and YouTube support. And it can be set up tomorrow.

Full Dolby Atmos Room Certification

WHAT YOU DO NOT NEED

- ✗ 7.1.4 speaker array — ceiling speakers, overhead, surrounds
- ✗ Dolby site inspection and room validation
- ✗ Dedicated mixing room reconstruction
- ✗ Timeline: 6–12 months minimum
- ✗ Cost: AED 80,000 – 300,000+
- ✗ Designed for film, music labels, TV broadcast
- ✗ Podcast listeners can't tell the difference

Not relevant for podcasts

Binaural Spatial Audio Production

WHAT DPS ACTUALLY NEEDS

- ✓ Software plugins installed on existing workstations
- ✓ Works with your existing DAW (Logic, Pro Tools, Reaper)
- ✓ No hardware changes to any studio room
- ✓ Timeline: setup in 1 day, first episode in 3 days
- ✓ Cost: AED 0 (free tools) to AED 1,100 (premium)
- ✓ Delivers through Apple Podcasts, Spotify, YouTube
- ✓ Listeners hear 3D immersive audio on any earphones

This is the path — start tomorrow

WHAT BINAURAL SPATIAL AUDIO SOUNDS LIKE

Instead of everything coming from "inside your head" as mono/stereo audio does on headphones — binaural processing places sounds in specific positions in 3D space around the listener. The host voice comes from slightly in front. The guest's voice comes from 30 degrees to the right. Room ambience wraps around from behind. On AirPods with head-tracking enabled, the sound stays anchored to the virtual room even when the listener turns their head. It is a fundamentally different, more immersive experience — and once someone hears it, they notice the difference immediately.

01 — DAY 1 (TOMORROW MORNING)

Morning: Install Everything

Everything in Day 1 is free. You will have a working spatial audio chain set up by lunchtime.

STEP 1 — Identify your DAW and operating system

9:00 AM · 15 minutes

1 — Check what DAW each studio uses — CHECK NOW

The tools you download depend on this. The three most common setups in Dubai podcast studios: Logic Pro (Mac), Pro Tools (Mac or PC), or Reaper (Mac or PC).

2 — If Logic Pro on Mac — you already have spatial audio built in — ALREADY PAID

Logic Pro 10.7.3+ includes native Dolby Atmos and binaural rendering at no extra cost. Open Logic → Preferences → Audio → Spatial Audio. It is already there.

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Logic Pro → File → Project Settings → Audio → Spatial Audio → Enable
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3 — If Pro Tools or Reaper — download SPARTA (free) — FREE

SPARTA (Spatial Audio Real-Time Applications) is a free, open-source binaural toolkit used by BBC R&D, Fraunhofer, and professional studios globally. It works as a VST/AU plugin in any DAW. Download at: leomccormack.github.io/sparta-site

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Download: SPARTA Suite → install BinauraliserNFr + AmbiRoomSim plugins
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STEP 2 — Download dearVR PRO free trial

10:00 AM · 20 minutes

1 — Go to dear-reality.com → dearVR PRO → Start Free Trial — 14-DAY FREE TRIAL

14-day full trial, no credit card needed. This is the industry-standard binaural plugin — used by Abbey Road Studios, Dolby, BBC. Works in Logic, Pro Tools, Reaper, Ableton, Nuendo.

2 — Install and activate in your DAW — INSTALL

It appears as a plugin insert on any audio track. Place it on the host microphone channel. You will immediately see a 3D sphere showing the position of that audio source. Drag the source to any position in 3D space — left, right, above, behind.

STEP 3 — Set up your binaural monitoring chain

11:00 AM · 30 minutes

1 — Get a pair of closed-back headphones for monitoring — ALREADY HAVE THESE

Spatial audio must be monitored on headphones, not speakers. Sony MDR-7506 or Audio-Technica ATH-M50x are the studio standard. You likely already have these. AirPods Pro or AirPods Max also work for testing the consumer experience.

2 **Enable binaural output in your DAW master bus** CONFIGURE

In Logic: Output → Dolby Atmos → Binaural Render Mode → On. This renders your spatial mix into a standard stereo signal that carries the 3D spatial information for headphones. In any DAW with dearVR: add dearVR Monitor on the master bus in "headphone monitoring" mode.

02 — DAYS 2-3

The Standard Spatial Mix Template

This is the exact spatial audio positioning template to use for every DPS podcast recording. Once it is set up as a session template, applying it to any new recording takes 5 minutes.

THE DPS SPATIAL AUDIO POSITIONING STANDARD

These positions are based on how humans naturally perceive conversation. The listener feels like they are in the room with the hosts — a physically present experience that is completely absent from standard stereo podcast audio.

SPATIAL POSITIONING MAP — LISTENER'S PERSPECTIVE (TOP VIEW)

HOST VOICE (PRIMARY)

Position: **Centre, 1.5m forward, head height**
This anchors the listener to the conversation. The main voice should always feel "in front" — commanding and clear.

GUEST VOICE

Position: **30° right, 1.2m, head height**
Natural seating position — feels like the guest is across the table. For video pods, match the physical camera angle.

ROOM AMBIENCE / REVERB

Position: **360° sphere, distance 3m, -18dB**
The DPS studio acoustic signature. Very low level but completely wraps the listener. This is what makes the room feel real — not just voices in a void.

INTRO/OUTRO MUSIC

Position: **Wide stereo, slightly behind, -6dB**
Music should feel like it comes from behind and around the listener — immersive bed

SECOND GUEST (IF ANY)

Position: **30° left, 1.2m, head height**
Mirrored from Guest 1. Listener feels seated between two people at a table.

under the vocal performance, not competing with it.

AD READS (IF ANY)

Position: **Centre, forward, slightly closer than host**
Ad reads should feel like the host is leaning toward the listener — closer, more intimate. This subtle shift unconsciously signals "important message."

DAY 2 — Build and save the DPS Spatial Template

Half day · 4 hours

1 **Open a new session in your DAW. Create tracks:** BUILD

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Track 1: Host Mic → dearVR PRO (position: centre 0°, 1.5m)
Track 2: Guest Mic → dearVR PRO (position: right 30°, 1.2m)
Track 3: Room Bus → AmbiRoomSim (SPARTA) → full sphere, distance 3m, -18dB
Track 4: Music → dearVR PRO (position: rear wide, -6dB)
Master: Binaural Render → export as stereo AAC/WAV
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2 **Record a 5-minute test conversation. Export. Listen on AirPods.** TEST

This is the moment it clicks. The voices will feel physically present in the room with you. Have two or three team members listen and give feedback. This is also your internal demo asset.

3 **Save as "DPS Spatial Template" — use this for every new booking** PERMANENT ASSET

In Logic: File → Save as Template. In Pro Tools: File → Save as Template. From now on, every session opens with spatial positioning pre-configured. The engineer just loads the template and adjusts levels.

DAY 3 — Produce first commercial-quality spatial episode

Full session

1 **Invite a willing existing client to record a spatial audio episode for free** — OUTREACH

This is your proof-of-concept and your first marketing asset. Brief them: "We are piloting a new immersive audio format — first in Dubai. We'd like to produce your next episode in spatial audio at no charge. In return, we'd love a short testimonial when you hear it."

2 **Produce, mix, and export two versions: standard stereo + spatial binaural** — DELIVER

Always deliver both. Standard stereo for maximum platform compatibility. Spatial binaural for AirPods, Spotify, Apple Podcasts, YouTube. The client publishes both — it signals to their audience that they are the early adopter in their niche.

03 — TOOLS & INVESTMENT

Exact Tools, Exact Costs

Logic Pro (built-in Dolby Atmos)

DAW SPATIAL ENGINE — MAC ONLY

If you already use Logic Pro, full Dolby Atmos binaural support is built in since v10.7.3. Zero additional cost. Simply enable in Project Settings → Spatial Audio. Best-in-class binaural renderer, trusted by professional studios globally.

AED 0 (already included in Logic Pro)

Start here if on Mac

dearVR PRO — Dear Reality

BINAURAL SPATIAL PLUGIN

Industry standard for binaural audio production. Used by Abbey Road, Dolby, Netflix. Places any sound source anywhere in 3D space. Works in Logic, Pro Tools, Reaper, Ableton, Nuendo. Simple XY pad + elevation control. 14-day free trial, then purchase.

€299 one-time (~AED 1,100)

Best investment if not using Logic

SPARTA Suite — Leomccormack

OPEN-SOURCE SPATIAL TOOLKIT

Free academic/professional toolkit developed with BBC R&D and Fraunhofer Institute. BinauraliserNFr plugin handles binaural rendering. AmbiRoomSim creates spatial room ambience. More technical than dearVR but full featured and trusted in broadcast production.

AED 0 — completely free

Best free path if not on Logic

Reaper (if you need a new DAW)

DAW — MAC + WINDOWS

The most cost-effective professional DAW. Supports all VST/AU spatial plugins. Highly configurable. Used by professional podcast studios and broadcast facilities globally. 60-day free trial, then AED 220 for a discounted licence (commercial use under $20K revenue: $225).

AED 220 one-time (~$60)

If no DAW currently or on Windows

ITEM	SCENARIO A — MAC + LOGIC	SCENARIO B — PRO TOOLS / REAPER	NOTES
DAW spatial audio engine	**AED 0 (built-in)**	**AED 0 (SPARTA free) or AED 1,100 (dearVR)**	dearVR is faster to learn; SPARTA is more powerful
Room simulation / ambience	**AED 0 (Logic Space Designer)**	**AED 0 (SPARTA AmbiRoomSim)**	Both free options are professional quality
Binaural monitoring plugin	**AED 0 (Logic built-in)**	**AED 0 (dearVR Monitor free version)**	Required to hear spatial mix on headphones correctly
Headphones for monitoring	**AED 0 (use existing studio cans)**	**AED 0**	Sony MDR-7506 or ATH-M50x — you likely have these
Engineer training (online)	**AED 0 (Dolby Academy free)**	**AED 0 (YouTube + Dolby Academy)**	Dolby Academy at learn.dolby.com — free professional courses
Total minimum investment	**AED 0**	**AED 0 – AED 1,100**	**Operational within 1 day**

04 — MARKETING THE CAPABILITY

How to Position and Sell Spatial Audio

The production capability is only worth something if it is marketed correctly. Most potential clients have never heard binaural spatial audio — they need to experience it before they can value it. The sales process is therefore: demo first, sell second.

DPS POSITIONING LINE — SPATIAL AUDIO

"The first podcast studio in the Arab World to offer immersive spatial audio production. Your listeners don't just hear your podcast. They feel like they're in the room."

THE DEMO SCRIPT

When a prospective client visits: hand them AirPods, play 60 seconds of a standard podcast. Then play 60 seconds of the same content in spatial audio. Do not say anything.

PRICING THE ADD-ON

Spatial audio mixing adds approximately 45–60 minutes of engineering time per episode. Price accordingly: **AED 350–500 per episode as a premium add-on** to the base session rate. For

Let them react. Every single person who hears it for the first time immediately says some version of *"what is that?"* or *"how did you do that?"* That reaction is the sale. Then you explain and price.

corporate packages, include it in the top-tier Sprint package at no visible surcharge — it is part of what justifies the premium package price.

INSTAGRAM / LINKEDIN POST — LAUNCH WEEK

"Put your AirPods in. 🎧

We just became the first podcast studio in the Arab World to offer immersive spatial audio production.

Instead of everything coming from inside your head — your listeners hear voices positioned in real 3D space. The host in front. The guest to the right. The room wrapping around them.

It sounds like being there. Not like listening.

First spatial audio episode drops this week. Link in bio to hear the difference. [Link to before/after comparison clip]

#DubaiPodcastStudio #SpatialAudio #ImmersiveAudio #PodcastProduction"

05 — OPTIONAL NEXT LEVEL

The Formal Certification Path — if You Want the Badge

Once the service is running and generating revenue, there is an optional path to formal engineer certification. This is not required to offer or market the service — but it adds a credibility layer that matters for enterprise clients.

TOMORROW **Start here**

Download tools, set up workflow, record first test. This document covers this completely. No certification needed to operate.

WEEK 1-2 **Dolby Academy — free online courses**

learn.dolby.com offers free professional training on Dolby Atmos production. Complete "Dolby Atmos Music: Introduction" and "Dolby Atmos for Headphones." Estimated time: 6–8 hours. Free certificate of completion. This is sufficient for DPS engineers to confidently produce and describe the service.

MONTH 1-2 **Avid Pro Tools | Dolby Atmos Certification**

A formal professional certification for mixing engineers. Available via ProMedia Training in partnership with Avid and Dolby. Online or in-person. Cost: approximately $1,500–2,000 per engineer. Not mandatory — but "Dolby Atmos Certified Engineer" on your team page is a strong enterprise sales signal. Next scheduled dates: check protoolstraining.com.

MONTH 6+ **Apple Spatial Audio Format (ASAF) — watch this space**

Apple unveiled ASAF (Apple Spatial Audio Format) at WWDC 2025. This expands on Dolby Atmos with Apple-native head-tracking and AirPods Max optimisation. As submission guidelines are formalised for Apple Podcasts, DPS should be first in MENA to submit content in this format. Monitor: developer.apple.com/audio for updates.

MONTH 9-12 **Dolby Atmos Studio Certification — only if warranted**

The full room certification (7.1.4 speaker array, Dolby site visit) becomes relevant only if DPS secures enterprise music/film post-production contracts. For podcasting alone, it is not necessary and not the right return on investment. Revisit this decision at the 12-month mark based on client demand.

06 — THE WEEK-ONE CHECKLIST

Day by Day — Week One

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Download tools. Install dearVR trial. Enable spatial in Logic. Headphone test chain.	Build session template. Apply positioning map. Internal test recording with team.	First client spatial session (free beta). Record, mix, deliver. Get testimonial.	Refine mix based on feedback. Create before/after audio comparison clip for marketing.	Begin Dolby Academy free courses online. Engineers complete intro module (2 hrs).	Post Instagram/LinkedIn launch content. "First in Arab World" announcement. Before/after clip.	Update website. Add "Spatial Audio" as a service. Add AED 350–500 add-on to booking page.

END OF WEEK ONE — WHAT YOU HAVE

A working spatial audio production capability. A published "first in Arab World" announcement. A before/after marketing demo clip. One real client episode delivered. An add-on service priced and listed. The groundwork laid for engineer certification. And a genuine, defensible technical differentiator that no other podcast studio in Dubai, Abu Dhabi, or the wider MENA region offers. Total out-of-pocket cost to reach this point: AED 0 to AED 1,100 depending on existing software.